

VALERIA CHRISTEN FERNANDEZ ALVAREZ

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SUMMARY

Bolivian-American Systems Engineering student and social innovator focused on closing the gap between technology and community impact. A U.S. citizen who completed my early education in Florida before relocating to Bolivia, I bring a bicultural perspective that informs both my technical training and my understanding of community needs across different contexts. Having worked closely with social organizations and community programs in Bolivia, I observed firsthand that mission-driven initiatives were often limited not by the commitment of their leaders, but by a lack of access to the technical tools and systems knowledge that could scale their reach. That observation drives my academic and professional direction: building the technical fluency and entrepreneurial toolkit to serve as a bridge between emerging technology and the social sector. Recognized for early leadership across student government, IEEE Women in Engineering, and international STEAM competitions, I bring both the analytical foundation of an engineer and the community lens of someone who has seen what impact looks like when infrastructure catches up to intention. My academic distinction has been recognized at the national level, including a Parliamentary Recognition from Bolivia's Plurinational Legislative Assembly for academic excellence and community contribution to the Department of La Paz (December 2024).

EDUCATION

Universidad Catolica Boliviana San Pablo La Paz, Bolivia

B.S. in Systems Engineering | Beca Bachiller Plata (Merit Scholarship) 2025 – Present

- Recipient of Beca Bachiller Plata – awarded by UCB San Pablo for extraordinary academic performance in final secondary years and outstanding entrance exam score (April 2025)
- Selected as Workshop Leader, IEEE Women in Engineering Student Branch (Freshman year)
- Facilitated 'Un Dia Siendo Ingeniera' workshop, inspiring girls in STEM (Nov 2025)
- Appointed Junior Vocal, Student Government – granted in recognition of exceptional early leadership during freshman year
- Elected Vocal, University Student Representative Council (CRUE – Centro Representante Universitario Estudiantil) – student governing body at UCB San Pablo

Colegio Desmaissieres R.R. Adoratrices La Paz, Bolivia

Bachiller en Humanidades | Valedictorian, 98% average 2014 – 2024

- Elected School President via school-wide election, 2023–2024
 - Designated as official judging panel member for school-wide anti-violence fair (Oct 2022)
 - Received Parliamentary Recognition from Bolivia's Plurinational Legislative Assembly for academic excellence and community contribution (Dec 2024)
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ADDITIONAL EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Futures Week / Construyendo Futuros 2030 La Paz, Bolivia

UNIFRANZ & The Millennium Project September 2023

- Participated in international futures-thinking program on global development and innovation

Graphic Design Elements for Non-Designers Colorado, USA (Online)

University of Colorado Boulder November 2020

- Color theory, publication design, and visual communication tools | Final grade: 97%

Digital Marketing Scholarship La Paz, Bolivia

Save the Children / Instituto de la Juventud April 2021

- Competitive scholarship for youth 14–20 covering social media, SEO, and email marketing

Technology & Innovation Bootcamp – UNICEF / AGETIC Bolivia Bolivia

“Programando soluciones para el mundo” – Mobile app development & entrepreneurship July 2021

- 30 academic hours; co-organized by Bolivia's Ministry of Education, UNICEF, and AGETIC

Geeky Latin@s – Virtual STEAM Program (7th Edition) Virtual

Empowering minorities and promoting inclusion in STEAM Feb – Jun 2024

- 26 academic hours; developed project Ecoguardianes, which won 1st place in STEAM social impact category (score 9.80/10)

El Semillero Estudiantil Bolivia

Student organization supported by Youth Ambassadors & World Learning Jan – Jun 2023

- Served as essential organizational support for student-led extracurricular activities

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Workshop Leader – IEEE Women in Engineering, UCB Student Branch La Paz, Bolivia

Universidad Catolica Boliviana San Pablo 2025 – Present

- Led a workshop as part of WIEE branch activities during freshman year
- Delivered hands-on STEM workshop to young girls as facilitator ('Un Dia Siendo Ingeniera')

Vocal – University Student Representative Council (CRUE), UCB San Pablo La Paz, Bolivia

Elected Vocal, Student Representative Council 2025 – Present

- Elected student representative on UCB San Pablo's governing council; advocates for student interests and participates in institutional decision-making

Volunteer – Centro de Rescate Animal Laika La Paz, Bolivia

Cat Volunteer (Catovoluntario) First Semester 2025 | 66 hours

- Recognized with 'Conexion Especial' award for distinctive dedication to animal welfare mission

Judging Panel Member – Anti-Violence Fair La Paz, Bolivia

Colegio Desmaissieres | Designated by Academic Director for outstanding academic performance October 2022

- Served as evaluator for 'Proceso de Despatriarcalización por una Vida Libre de Violencia'

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- 1st Place, Ecoguardianes – STEAM Social Impact Projects category, Geeky Latin@s international competition; team score 9.80/10 (June 2024)
- Top 12 Finalist, Academia del Saber – nationally televised academic competition for Bolivia's top students, Season 1
- Parliamentary Recognition, Asamblea Legislativa Plurinacional de Bolivia – for academic excellence, community commitment, and contribution to the Department of La Paz (December 2024)
- Valedictorian (Top Graduate), Colegio Desmaissieres – 98% average (2024)
- Colegio Boliviano Japones – 91.3% average (2020)
- English Tournament Award, Colegio Boliviano Japones (2018)
- 'Conexión Especial' Recognition, Centro de Rescate Animal Laika (June 2025)

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages

Spanish (native) | English (native/bilingual)

Technical

HTML & CSS (intermediate) | Java, Python, C++ (intermediate) | Microsoft Office (intermediate) | PowerPoint (advanced)

Design

Canva (intermediate) | MediBang Illustrator (advanced) | Graphic design & visual communication | Traditional & digital art (intermediate)